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Coat and Outerwear Zone



SAFETY IS THE 4TH S

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Shoe and Boot Zone

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Shoe and Boot Zone

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Entry Console or Bench

Tip the drawer out onto the bench. Dead batteries, pens that do not write, single earbuds, sunscreen from three summers ago and takeaway menus all go now. Anything you would not want while wearing your outdoor shoes belongs in a different room.



SAFETY IS THE 4TH S

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Entry Console or Bench

Divide the drawer into named sections and hold to them: dog lead and waste bags, sun cream and insect spray, a torch, one pen. Bags and the vacuum go underneath the bench, never on the seat.



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Entry Console or Bench

Take the drawer fully out and tip the sand and crumbs out of its corners. Wipe the seat itself, which collects the same grit as the floor because people sit on it in outdoor clothes.



SAFETY IS THE 4TH S

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Entry Console or Bench

Fix the console to the wall if it is taller than it is deep, because children climb open drawer fronts like a ladder. Move the box cutter and the scissors out of the shallow drawer that opens at toddler head height.



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Entry Console or Bench

Write the three permitted top items on a card and tape it inside the drawer, so the cap survives everyone who did not read this book.



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Entry Console or Bench

Whoever clears the dinner table carries the plates past the bench and takes the top back to three on the way through, which adds nothing to a trip already being made. The seat is the signal, not the top: if you cannot sit down to lace a boot without lifting something, the bench has stopped being a bench. Recovery is one armful ...



SAFETY IS THE 4TH S

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Door, Mat, and Immediate Floor

Nothing is stored on this patch of floor, so the recycling bag, the parcel waiting to go back and the sports kit all move tonight. Give outgoing returns one named spot in another room and carry the rest to where they actually belong.



SAFETY IS THE 4TH S

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Door, Mat, and Immediate Floor

Two mats and only two. Coarse outside to scrape, absorbent inside to dry. The inside mat needs to be long enough that both feet land on it while walking, and most are not, which is exactly how the grit gets past.



SAFETY IS THE 4TH S

27 / 78

Door, Mat, and Immediate Floor

Vacuum the inside mat on both faces, then take it outdoors, beat it and wash it. Run a cloth along the bottom edge of the door and along the threshold strip, because that dark line is all the grit the mat never caught.



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SAFETY ENTRYWAY 28 / 78 Door, Mat, and Immediate Floor A curled mat corner and a mat that slides on hard floor are the two ways this threshold puts somebody down. Grip or tape the edges flat, and dry the floor immediately when someone comes in soaked rather than leaving it to evaporate. SAFETY IS THE 4TH S	STANDARDIZE ENTRYWAY 29 / 78 Door, Mat, and Immediate Floor Run a thin line of tape around where the mat should sit, so a mat kicked out of position is obvious to anyone walking in rather than only to you. SAFETY IS THE 4TH S	SUSTAIN ENTRYWAY 30 / 78 Door, Mat, and Immediate Floor The mat sits on the route back to the vacuum cupboard, so whoever ran the vacuum straightens and cleans it last, every time. Overnight the job is smaller: the last person in nudges it back inside its taped outline with a foot. Slip is visible before you reach the door, as a curled corner outside the tape or a grey line of grit ... SAFETY IS THE 4TH S
SORT KITCHEN 31 / 78 Primary Prep Counter Take everything off the counter and set it on the dining table, then let only three things back: what you cut on, what you cut with, and what you season with. The vitamins, the second cutting board, the bread bag and the pile of receipts find homes elsewhere or leave. SAFETY IS THE 4TH S	STRAIGHTEN KITCHEN 32 / 78 Primary Prep Counter Put the board where you already stand without thinking, then build outward from it. Knives on a wall strip or in a block on your dominant side, oil and salt behind the board rather than beside it, mixing bowls in the cabinet directly underneath so you can reach one without turning around. SAFETY IS THE 4TH S	SHINE KITCHEN 33 / 78 Primary Prep Counter Lift the toaster and the kettle instead of wiping around them, because crumbs collect under the appliance feet and never move. Run a damp cloth along the seam where the counter meets the backsplash, and shake the toaster crumb tray out over the bin. SAFETY IS THE 4TH S
SAFETY KITCHEN 34 / 78 Primary Prep Counter Knives belong in a block, on a magnetic strip, or in a bladed sleeve in a drawer, never loose among the utensils and never blade-up in the drying rack. Keep the kettle and toaster cords off the sink side of the counter, where a wet hand meets them. SAFETY IS THE 4TH S	STANDARDIZE KITCHEN 35 / 78 Primary Prep Counter Mark the clear run so it is not a matter of opinion. A short strip of tape under the counter lip, or the outline of the board itself, tells everyone in the house where the work surface starts and that it stays empty. SAFETY IS THE 4TH S	SUSTAIN KITCHEN 36 / 78 Primary Prep Counter Whoever presses start on the dishwasher puts the board back down onto bare counter, about a minute, and that settles the whole run. The board is the gauge: if it will not sit flat, or you have to move something to lay it down, the clear run has gone. Recovery is sweeping the strays into a basket and carrying the basket out of ... SAFETY IS THE 4TH S

SORT

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KITCHEN

Sink and Dishwashing Zone

Pull everything out from under the sink and line it up on the floor. Combine the three half-empty bottles of the same spray, bin what has separated or lost its label, and move out anything that is not dish, sink, or plumbing related, because that cabinet gets damp and is the wrong home for spare bulbs, paper goods, or vases.



SAFETY IS THE 4TH S

STRAIGHTEN

38 / 78

KITCHEN

Sink and Dishwashing Zone

Soap and brush live in a caddy you can lift with one wet hand, so wiping under them takes no planning. Dishwasher tablets go in a container beside the machine rather than across the room, and the towel gets a bar within reach of somebody already standing at the basin.



SAFETY IS THE 4TH S

SHINE

39 / 78

KITCHEN

Sink and Dishwashing Zone

The sponge is the dirtiest object in the room: wring it out and stand it on edge after every wash, and retire it the day it smells while dry. Scrub the drain flange, wipe the rubber seal all the way around the dishwasher door, and pull the dishwasher filter out and rinse it, because a filter that has never come out since the ...



SAFETY IS THE 4TH S

SAFETY

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KITCHEN

Sink and Dishwashing Zone

Never store bleach beside an ammonia or toilet cleaner under this sink, and never combine them in the basin; keep them apart, capped, and labels facing out. If small children live here or visit, this is the one kitchen cabinet that genuinely earns a latch.



SAFETY IS THE 4TH S

STANDARDIZE

41 / 78

KITCHEN

Sink and Dishwashing Zone

Write the empty-sink standard on a card taped inside the cabinet door: dishes in the machine or washed, basin wiped, brush standing, towel hung. A standard is the best way you know today, written down.



SAFETY IS THE 4TH S

SUSTAIN

42 / 78

KITCHEN

Sink and Dishwashing Zone

Whoever switches the kitchen light off empties the basin and wipes it dry, two minutes, and that person is different every night, which is why the rule hangs on the switch rather than on a name. The morning tells you: one bowl left overnight is a full sink by tomorrow night, because a basin with something in it reads as ...



SAFETY IS THE 4TH S

SORT

43 / 78

KITCHEN

Upper Cabinet Zone

Count the mugs, then count the people who drink from them. The conference giveaway, the chipped one, and the one nobody ever chooses off the shelf come out first, because chips and crazed glaze are the easy calls and they shorten the argument about the rest.



SAFETY IS THE 4TH S

STRAIGHTEN

44 / 78

KITCHEN

Upper Cabinet Zone

Put dinner plates and everyday bowls at eye level on the side nearest the dishwasher or the table, glasses beside them, and send the serving platters and the punch bowl to the top shelf, where a step stool is an honest once-a-year cost.



SAFETY IS THE 4TH S

SHINE

45 / 78

KITCHEN

Upper Cabinet Zone

Take each shelf completely empty before wiping, because the band of dust at the back is how you find out it has not been cleared in years. Wipe the underside of the cabinet nearest the hob, where a greasy film settles that you only see when you look at it from an angle.



SAFETY IS THE 4TH S

KITCHEN

Upper Cabinet Zone

Heavy and breakable do not belong above head height. The stack of casserole dishes or the cast iron lid stored overhead is the one that eventually comes down on somebody, so move that weight low. Use a real step stool, never a chair edge and never an open drawer front.



SAFETY IS THE 4TH S

KITCHEN

Upper Cabinet Zone

Label the shelf edge rather than the contents: plates, bowls, glasses, mugs. Then anyone emptying the dishwasher can put things away correctly without asking you where they go.



SAFETY IS THE 4TH S

KITCHEN

Upper Cabinet Zone

Emptying the dishwasher is the check, done by whoever is emptying it, so the household audits this zone several times a week without an extra minute. The signal comes to your hand: a clean mug you cannot lift without moving another, or a plate with nowhere obvious to go. Either means the shelf is over its limit, and recovery is ...



SAFETY IS THE 4TH S

KITCHEN

Lower Cabinet and Cookware Zone

Empty the entire cabinet onto the floor, which is the only way you will ever find the third saucepan and the wok bought for one weekend. Keep what actually cooked something in the past year. Nonstick worn through to the metal in the middle is not a spare, it is finished, and it goes to metal recycling rather than to the back of ...



SAFETY IS THE 4TH S

KITCHEN

Lower Cabinet and Cookware Zone

Nest by size but cap any stack at three, with a cloth or a sheet of paper between coated surfaces. Lids stand in a rack or on a rail inside the door, and baking sheets go on edge in a divider so you stop lifting three to reach the fourth.



SAFETY IS THE 4TH S

KITCHEN

Lower Cabinet and Cookware Zone

Wipe the shelf floor itself, where oil creeps down from pan bases and holds dust into a tacky film that resists a dry cloth. While everything is out, twist every pan handle and tighten any rivet or screw that moves.



SAFETY IS THE 4TH S

KITCHEN

Lower Cabinet and Cookware Zone

Keep the cast iron and the full stockpot on the cabinet floor, never above waist height, and lift them from a squat rather than bending over the open door. If a stack slides when the door is closed hard, it will one day land on a foot, so build the stack so it survives a slam.



SAFETY IS THE 4TH S

KITCHEN

Lower Cabinet and Cookware Zone

Size the divider slots to your actual pans and write the pan on the front edge of each slot, so the wide skillet slot cannot quietly become the place lids get dropped.



SAFETY IS THE 4TH S

KITCHEN

Lower Cabinet and Cookware Zone

When the pans come off the drying rack they go back into their named slots, done by whoever set them there to dry. The hob is the tell. A pan that sleeps on the burner is not laziness, it is a slot that costs a crouch to reach, and the pan is reporting that honestly. Recovery is changing the slot rather than the person: move ...



SAFETY IS THE 4TH S

Sort

55 / 78

Primary Bedroom**Bed and Bedding Zone**

Strip the bed and pull out everything underneath it. Sheets worn thin at the hip, blankets gone pillled and scratchy, and pillows that stay folded in half when you bend them are finished; they leave as rags or textile recycling, not as spares for a guest who never comes.



SAFETY IS THE 4TH S

Straighten

56 / 78

Primary Bedroom**Bed and Bedding Zone**

Store each sheet set folded inside one of its own pillowcases so the flat sheet and the fitted sheet stop travelling separately, and keep this bed's linen on one shelf instead of stacked in with guest doubles and kid singles.



SAFETY IS THE 4TH S

Shine

57 / 78

Primary Bedroom**Bed and Bedding Zone**

With the mattress bare, vacuum the whole surface and the seam where the protector tucks under, then run the vacuum head down behind the headboard where dust and hair pack against the wall.



SAFETY IS THE 4TH S

Safety

58 / 78

Primary Bedroom**Bed and Bedding Zone**

Nothing goes under the bed that sticks out into the strip of floor you cross in the dark, and nothing heavy sits on a headboard shelf directly above where your head rests.



SAFETY IS THE 4TH S

Standardize

59 / 78

Primary Bedroom**Bed and Bedding Zone**

Write down what a made bed means in this house, down to how many pillows go on and whether the duvet is folded back or pulled flat, so it looks the same on the mornings you do it and the mornings someone else does. A standard is the best way you know today, written down.



SAFETY IS THE 4TH S

Sustain

60 / 78

Primary Bedroom**Bed and Bedding Zone**

Make the bed before you leave the room, while the duvet is still thrown back and it takes one pull. In a two person bed it belongs to whoever gets up second, worth agreeing out loud once rather than negotiating every morning. The cover is the signal: a made bed holds the agreed pillows and nothing else, so folded laundry on it ...



SAFETY IS THE 4TH S

Sort

61 / 78

Primary Bedroom**Primary Closet**

Pull out anything you have not worn in a year, anything waiting on a repair you are never going to make, and every wire hanger and plastic sheath the dry cleaner sent home. Winter coats and heavy knits go into a labelled bin or the guest wardrobe so the rod carries only what this month asks for.



SAFETY IS THE 4TH S

Straighten

62 / 78

Primary Bedroom**Primary Closet**

Switch to one hanger style so everything hangs at the same depth and the row reads flat, group by type and then by shade, and hang the short items together so the floor under them opens up for the shoe rack. Bags stand up on the shelf rather than nesting inside one another where you forget the inner three.



SAFETY IS THE 4TH S

Shine

63 / 78

Primary Bedroom**Primary Closet**

Clear the floor completely, vacuum it and the corners, wipe the shelf edges and the rod itself where hangers leave a grey line, and check the back wall and skirting for damp before the shoes go back down.



SAFETY IS THE 4TH S

SAFETY 64 / 78 PRIMARY BEDROOM Primary Closet An overloaded rod pulls its brackets out of the plasterboard, and it does it while you are standing underneath reaching in. Lean your weight on it and see, anchor the brackets into a stud, and get the shoe pile off the floor so you are not standing on a heel in the dark. SAFETY IS THE 4TH S	STANDARDIZE 65 / 78 PRIMARY BEDROOM Primary Closet The rod is full when you cannot slide two fingers between hangers. From there it is one in, one out, and the bare stretch of rod at the end stays bare, because that is where the next coat lands. SAFETY IS THE 4TH S	SUSTAIN 66 / 78 PRIMARY BEDROOM Primary Closet Turn every hanger backwards at the start of a season and turn each one the right way round as you wear the item, so the record keeps itself. Slip gets measured with two fingers: when they will not fit between hangers the rod is full, and from there it is one in, one out. Recovery is not a purge, it is reading the hangers still ... SAFETY IS THE 4TH S
SORT 67 / 78 PRIMARY BATHROOM Vanity Counter Pull everything off the counter onto a towel and put back only what your hands touched today and yesterday. The travel bottles, the sample sachets, and the hair tie graveyard go into a drawer or out of the room entirely. SAFETY IS THE 4TH S	STRAIGHTEN 68 / 78 PRIMARY BATHROOM Vanity Counter Give the daily set one tray, on the side you reach with your dominant hand. The heat tool gets a heat-safe rest and its cord parks behind the basin rather than draped across it. SAFETY IS THE 4TH S	SHINE 69 / 78 PRIMARY BATHROOM Vanity Counter Wipe the tray, then the counter under it, then the base of the faucet where toothpaste dries into a crust. Finish with the mirror and the light switch plate, the thing in this room nobody ever wipes. SAFETY IS THE 4TH S
SAFETY 70 / 78 PRIMARY BATHROOM Vanity Counter Water and a plugged-in dryer share one small surface in here. Keep the cord on the far side of the basin from the tap, and pull the plug at the wall the moment you set the tool down, not once your hair is finished. SAFETY IS THE 4TH S	STANDARDIZE 71 / 78 PRIMARY BATHROOM Vanity Counter Write the four-product limit on a strip of tape stuck under the tray, and tape a photo of the cleared counter inside the vanity door. A fifth bottle then has something to argue with before it lands. SAFETY IS THE 4TH S	SUSTAIN 72 / 78 PRIMARY BATHROOM Vanity Counter The tray goes back to match the photo when you rinse your toothbrush at night, same moment every night, each adult resetting their own products. Twenty seconds. Slip is a fifth bottle standing on bare stone, seen from the door before anything else, because this counter's whole standard is the emptiness either side of the basin ... SAFETY IS THE 4TH S

Sort

73 / 78

Primary Bathroom**Under-Sink Cabinet**

Take it all out and line it up on the floor by job: glass, tub and tile, toilet, drain, polish. You will find three half-full bottles of the same thing and one you cannot identify, and the one you cannot identify goes.



SAFETY IS THE 4TH S

Straighten

74 / 78

Primary Bathroom**Under-Sink Cabinet**

Build the bins around the P-trap instead of fighting it, keeping the joint and the valves visible. Paper goods and bulk toiletries take the side with headroom, and sprays sit at the front where you can read a label without kneeling.



SAFETY IS THE 4TH S

Shine

75 / 78

Primary Bathroom**Under-Sink Cabinet**

Wipe the cabinet floor and look hard for a dark ring or a soft patch in the board, which is what a slow leak looks like before it looks like water. Wipe the neck of every bottle before it goes back so the pale tray never turns sticky.



SAFETY IS THE 4TH S

Safety

76 / 78

Primary Bathroom**Under-Sink Cabinet**

Never store bleach where it can tip into an ammonia-based cleaner, and never decant anything into a drink bottle. This cabinet sits at toddler height, so if small children come through the house, fit a magnetic catch or move the chemistry above the sink line.



SAFETY IS THE 4TH S

Standardize

77 / 78

Primary Bathroom**Under-Sink Cabinet**

One open container per job, backstock capped at two. Label the front edge of each bin with the job rather than the brand, so the bowl cleaner cannot quietly end up among the glass sprays.



SAFETY IS THE 4TH S

Sustain

78 / 78

Primary Bathroom**Under-Sink Cabinet**

Every hand soap refill is a leak check: crouch, run your eyes over the cabinet floor and the trap joint, then close the doors. Ten seconds, by whoever refilled the soap. Slip is anything stacked on the pale tray or standing where it hides the trap, because the tray only works if it can show you a drip you were not expecting ...



SAFETY IS THE 4TH S

The standards that keep these zones

ENTRYWAY · LANDING ZONE

The surface holds the tray and the folder and nothing else, and keys never ride out of the house in a coat pocket that lives on a hanger.

| As you take your coat off, your hands are already full and already stopped. That is the moment everything in them goes into the tray.

ENTRYWAY · COAT AND OUTERWEAR ZONE

Two empty hooks at all times. If there is no empty hook, one coat is in the wrong room.

| On the first morning cold enough that you go looking for gloves, that is the seasonal swap. Do it that morning, standing there, rather than noting it for later.

ENTRYWAY · SHOE AND BOOT ZONE

Two pairs per person at the door, soles down, everything else lives somewhere that is not the entryway.

| On the night the bins go out, the boot tray goes out with them and comes back empty.

ENTRYWAY · ENTRY CONSOLE OR BENCH

Three items on the top, an empty seat, and every drawer section holding one named category.

| You already open this drawer to put the dog lead back after a walk. While it is open, glance at the top and take it back to three.

ENTRYWAY · DOOR, MAT, AND IMMEDIATE FLOOR

Nothing is stored on the floor inside the door's swing, ever, and both mats lie flat inside their taped outline.

| Whoever comes home last and locks the door straightens the mat with a foot before turning the key.

KITCHEN · PRIMARY PREP COUNTER

The clear run stays clear: one board, one knife block or strip, one seasoning within reach, and nothing parked on the work surface overnight.

| When you press start on the dishwasher, the counter clears.

KITCHEN · SINK AND DISHWASHING ZONE

Empty sink, dry basin, one brush and one sponge standing, cleaners on one tray with the plumbing visible.

| When the coffee brews in the morning, the sink gets checked and cleared.

KITCHEN · UPPER CABINET ZONE

Daily dishes between shoulder and eye height, one category per stack, top shelf reserved for what you use less than monthly.

| Every time the clean dishwasher gets emptied.

KITCHEN · LOWER CABINET AND COOKWARE ZONE

Stacks capped at three, lids racked, heaviest pieces on the cabinet floor, and the two nightly pans at the front.

| When the pans come off the drying rack.

PRIMARY BEDROOM · BED AND BEDDING ZONE

Two sheet sets for this bed, each folded inside its own pillowcase; a made bed means the agreed pillow count and nothing else on the cover.

| When you strip the bed to wash the sheets, look underneath it before the clean set goes on.

PRIMARY BEDROOM · PRIMARY CLOSET

One hanger style, grouped by type then shade, two fingers of space between items, and one in one out once the rod is full.

| When you hang up the first coat of a new season, turn every hanger on the rod backwards and start the count again.

PRIMARY BATHROOM · VANITY COUNTER

The counter carries one liftable tray and nothing beside it. Anything used less than daily lives behind a door.

| The nightly toothbrush rinse. The tray goes back to the photo before you leave the room.

PRIMARY BATHROOM · UNDER-SINK CABINET

The P-trap and both shut-off valves stay in plain sight, one open bottle per job, backstock capped at two.

Every hand soap refill. Crouch, check the cabinet floor, then close the doors.